

MAGIC CITY GAMES

STRATEGY GUIDE

Pacing, execution, and recovery for every announced event

Bolder Athlete

Get Bolder. Not Older.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This guide covers every announced event at the Magic City Games. For each event you will find the workout description with age-group-specific standards, a strategic overview, pacing and execution notes, key mistakes to avoid, a tailored warm-up, and a post-event cool-down.

One principle governs everything in this guide:

- **Minimums Over Maximums.** In a multi-event competition, the athlete who manages output across all events outperforms the one who red-lines the first event and limps through the last.

Competition mindset: Your warm-ups in this guide follow the Bolder three-phase protocol (General Elevation, Movement Preparation, Specific Ramp). Cool-downs follow the three-phase recovery protocol (Aerobic Flush, Session-Specific Mobility, Soft Tissue). Treat warm-ups and cool-downs as non-negotiable. They protect your body between events and compound your readiness across the weekend.

Note on Naughty Nancy: Naughty Nancy is only programmed for the 35-54 divisions at this event. Athletes in the 55-59, 60-64, 65-69, and 70+ divisions will skip this event. The strategy and warm-up for Nancy applies to the 35-54 brackets only.

EVENT 1 — NAUGHTY NANCY

Time Cap: 20:00

Workout

4 Rounds For Time:

- 600 meter Run
- 25 Overhead Squats

Age Group Standards

Age Group	Prescription
35-39 M / F	135 lb / 95 lb
40-44 M / F	135 lb / 95 lb
45-49 M / F	115 lb / 75 lb
50-54 M / F	95 lb / 65 lb
55+ Divisions	Not competing in this event

Strategic Overview

Zone: Orange. This is a long aerobic grinder with a heavy overhead-squat element. Total work is roughly 2,400 meters of running paired with 100 overhead squats. The athlete who wins this event holds a steady pace from rep one and treats the overhead squat as the controlled element — not the run.

The trap is the first round. A fast 600 meter opener feels great, but it cooks the legs and the breathing for the overhead squats that follow. The shoulders, mid-back, and hip flexors all take a beating from sustained overhead positions while breathing hard. Once that fatigue compounds in rounds 3 and 4, the wheels come off.

Pacing and Execution

Round 1 — Anchor the pace: The 600 meter run should feel conversational. Think Zone 2 to lower Orange — around 70-75% of your mile race pace. Walk into the bar, not run. Breath should be controlled before you snatch or clean the bar to the rack.

Overhead squats — Plan your breaks: 25 reps unbroken is a trap for most athletes. The smart play is two sets every round (15-10, 13-12, or 10-10-5). The break gives the shoulders a brief reset and lets you reset the bar position. Drop and reset is faster than grinding through a sloppy set with bent elbows.

Rounds 2-3 — Hold the line: This is where the event is won or lost. Resist the urge to push the second run because round one felt easy. Match round 1 splits exactly. The overhead squats will feel harder — that is normal. Stay with your planned break scheme.

Round 4 — Empty the tank: Push the final run if the legs allow it. The final set of overhead squats can be broken into smaller pieces (5-5-5-5 if needed) — the goal is to finish, not to be pretty. If you have managed your output through rounds 1-3, you will have something left here.

Key Mistakes to Avoid

- Sprinting the first 600 meter run. The cost compounds across all four rounds.
- Going for unbroken overhead squats in round one. Save the unbroken set for round 4 if it is there — not before.
- Letting the bar drift forward. As shoulders fatigue, the bar pulls forward and the squat collapses. Active shoulders, eyes forward, vertical bar path.
- Walking the run. The run pace should be slow but it is still a run. Walking turns the time cap into a real risk.

Warm-Up

Phase 1 — General Elevation (5 min): Easy bike or row. Build heart rate to Yellow zone. Light sweat by the end.

Phase 2 — Movement Preparation (5 min): Banded shoulder distractions, thoracic extensions over a foam roller, PVC pass-throughs, PVC overhead squats x 10, ankle rocks, glute bridges. Spend extra time in the overhead position.

Phase 3 — Specific Ramp (8-10 min): Easy 200 meter jog to wake up the running rhythm. Then empty barbell snatch grip overhead squat x 10 → add 30-50% x 5 → 60-70% x 3 → 80% x 2 → working weight x 2-3. 200 meter run at your planned race pace, walk back. 5 overhead squats at working weight to confirm bar position post-run. One more 100 meter pickup at race pace and walk back. Final 90 seconds: stand over the bar, breathe, visualize the first round.

Cool-Down

Phase 1 — Aerobic Flush (3-5 min): Easy walk, bike, or row at Blue zone. Let heart rate settle back to Zone 1.

Phase 2 — Session-Specific Mobility (3-5 min): Lat stretch on the rig (30 sec/side), thoracic openers on a foam roller, calf stretch, hip flexor stretch (45 sec/side).

Phase 3 — Soft Tissue (3-5 min): Foam roll quads and calves, lacrosse ball on the upper traps and lats, ankle circles. Hydrate and refuel. You have events ahead.

EVENT 2 — SEMI-NATE

Time Cap: 15:00

Workout

8 Rounds For Time (35-59 divisions). 60+ divisions: 4 rounds, then 4 rounds with movement change at the halfway point. See standards table.

- Ring or Bar Muscle-Ups (varies by division)
- Strict or Kipping HSPU (varies by division)
- Dumbbell Snatch (varies by division)

Age Group Standards

Age Group	Prescription
35-39 M	8 rds: 4 RMU / 7 Strict HSPU / 12 DB Snatch 50 lb
35-39 F	8 rds: 3 RMU / 6 Strict HSPU / 12 DB Snatch 35 lb
40-44 M	8 rds: 3 RMU / 6 Strict HSPU / 12 DB Snatch 50 lb
40-44 F	8 rds: 2 RMU / 5 Strict HSPU / 12 DB Snatch 35 lb
45-49 M	8 rds: 3 RMU / 6 HSPU (kip) / 12 DB Snatch 50 lb
45-49 F	8 rds: 2 RMU / 6 HSPU (kip) / 12 DB Snatch 35 lb
50-54 M	8 rds: 3 RMU / 6 HSPU (kip) / 12 DB Snatch 50 lb
50-54 F	8 rds: 3 BMU / 6 HSPU (kip) / 12 DB Snatch 35 lb
55-59 M	8 rds: 4 BMU / 6 HSPU (kip) / 12 DB Snatch 35 lb
55-59 F	8 rds: 3 BMU / 6 HSPU (kip) / 12 DB Snatch 20 lb
60+ M	4 rds: 7 C2B / 5 HSPU (kip) / 10 DB Snatch 35 lb, then 4 rds: 3 BMU / 5 HSPU / 10 DB Snatch 35 lb
60+ F	4 rds: 6 C2B / 5 HSPU (kip) / 10 DB Snatch 20 lb, then 4 rds: 2 BMU / 5 HSPU / 10 DB Snatch 20 lb

Strategic Overview

Zone: Orange to lower Red. This is too long for an all-out effort — sustained high intensity, not a sprint. The shoulders are the limiting factor across every division — muscle-ups, HSPU, and dumbbell snatch all stack onto the same musculature. Pacing is shoulder management within a sustained-effort window, not heart rate management.

Eight rounds across a 15-minute cap means rounds need to land in the 1:30-1:45 range to finish under the cap. The DB snatch is the recovery movement — it lets the shoulders briefly cycle out of the strict-pressing pattern. The bottleneck for almost every athlete is the strict HSPU.

Pacing and Execution

Muscle-ups — Stay on the rings: Break only if absolutely necessary. For 2-4 rep sets, the elite athlete keeps these unbroken across all 8 rounds. If the rings start to feel sticky in round 5 or 6, that is the moment to assess — not before. A single break in round 6 to preserve the next two rounds is smart. Breaking in round 1 is a strategic error.

Strict HSPU — Hold the unbroken set: Same principle. Break only if absolutely necessary. Strict HSPU at 6-7 reps unbroken is well within the capacity of an athlete competing here. The breakdown signals to watch are head position drifting forward and the press slowing dramatically on the last rep. If you see those, break the next set into 4-2 or 5-2. Until then, stay on the wall.

Kipping HSPU: Cycle through unbroken when prescribed. Tight kip rhythm, no extended arches or pauses, hands stay set. The kip should be efficient enough that breaking is never necessary.

DB Snatch — Touch-and-go, no singles: 12 reps unbroken every round. The dumbbell snatch is the recovery movement here — it lets the shoulders briefly cycle out of the strict-pressing pattern while the hips do the work. Alternating hands every rep, smooth turnover. Singles waste time and break the rhythm of the workout.

Key Mistakes to Avoid

- Breaking muscle-ups, HSPU, or DB snatch out of caution. The prescription is set up for unbroken work — unnecessary breaks cost transition time and rhythm.
- Cycling DB snatch as singles. The hip drive is the recovery; alternating touch-and-go is faster and conserves more grip than singles.
- Long transitions between stations. Walk with purpose. Three saved seconds per transition is 24 seconds across the workout — enough to move on the leaderboard.
- Treating round 1 like a sprint. The work in round 1 should match round 8. Build into the workout, then assess in rounds 5-6 whether to push or hold.

Warm-Up

Phase 1 — General Elevation (5 min): Easy bike or row. Build heart rate to Yellow zone. Get the shoulders warm without fatiguing them.

Phase 2 — Movement Preparation (5-7 min): Band pull-aparts x 15, scap pull-ups x 10, ring rows x 10, banded lat distractions (30 sec/side), wall walks x 3, hollow holds x 30 sec, pike push-ups against a wall x 8, kip swings on the rings x 5, kip swings on the bar x 5. Light DB snatch with the warm-up dumbbell x 5 each side. Activate without fatiguing.

Phase 3 — Specific Ramp (8-10 min): 2-3 strict HSPU (or kipping at half-speed) → 2 muscle-ups (low-effort transitions, no big sets) → 5 DB snatches at workout weight. Walk through the

transitions. One final round at 50% effort to lock in the rhythm. Then 2-3 minutes of rest, breathing, and visualization before the start.

Cool-Down

Phase 1 — Aerobic Flush (3-5 min): Easy walk, bike, or row at Blue zone. Let heart rate settle back to Zone 1.

Phase 2 — Session-Specific Mobility (3-5 min): Doorway pec stretch (45 sec/side), banded shoulder distractions, child's pose with thoracic rotation, lat stretch on the rig.

Phase 3 — Soft Tissue (3-5 min): Lacrosse ball on lats, pecs, and rear delts. Foam roll the upper back. Wrist mobility circles. Hydrate, refuel, and protect those shoulders — you have events ahead.

EVENT 3 — THE COMMUTE

Time Cap: 15:00

Workout

For Time:

- Burpee Box Jump Overs (volume varies by division)
- 1.5 mile Bicycle
- Burpee Box Jump Overs (matching set)

Age Group Standards

Age Group	Prescription
35-49 M	50 BBJO 24" / 1.5 mi Bike / 50 BBJO
35-49 F	50 BBJO 20" / 1.5 mi Bike / 50 BBJO
50-64 M	40 BBJO 24" / 1.5 mi Bike / 40 BBJO
50-64 F	40 BBJO 20" / 1.5 mi Bike / 40 BBJO
65+ M	30 BBJO 24" (step-up permitted) / 1.5 mi Bike / 30 BBJO
65+ F	30 BBJO 20" (step-up permitted) / 1.5 mi Bike / 30 BBJO

Strategic Overview

Zone: Orange on the burpees, recover toward Zone 3 on the bike, then Zone 4-5 on the second set of burpees to finish. This is a longer workout, not a sprint. The athlete who treats it like a 15-minute test rather than a 5-minute test wins this one.

This is fundamentally a burpee workout. The bike is your reset window in the middle, and the second set of burpees is where the event is decided. The mistake most athletes make is going too hard on the first 50 (or 40, or 30) burpees because they feel fresh. Held in Orange, the first set sets up a controlled bike where the heart rate can drop into Zone 3, and a final push in Zone 4-5 to close out the work.

Pacing and Execution

First set BBJO — Orange and steady: Hold Orange zone for the entire first set. Pick a sustainable cadence — roughly one rep every 4-5 seconds for most athletes — and lock it in for all 50 (or 40, or 30). The breathing should stay controlled. If you are gasping in the first 20 reps, you are too hot. Step up if your division allows it; the savings on the legs and heart rate compound across the workout.

Bike — Active recovery toward Zone 3: Get on the bike with the goal of bringing the heart rate down. The first 30-45 seconds should be a deliberate decel. Then settle into a moderate Zone 3 pace — working, but breathing through the nose is achievable. The 1.5 miles will take roughly 4-5 minutes. Do not race the bike. The bike is your tool to set up the finish.

Second set BBJO — Empty the tank: This is where the event is won. Coming off the bike with a heart rate that has dropped into Zone 3, you can now climb to Zone 4-5 and stay there. The legs will feel heavy for the first 5-8 reps; push through. Match or beat your first-set cadence. The chest stays up, the jump stays tall, and the breathing climbs. This is the part of the workout where you spend everything you saved.

Key Mistakes to Avoid

- Pushing the first set of burpees into Red zone. The cost compounds across the bike and the second set. Hold Orange.
- Racing the bike. The bike is the recovery window that sets up the final push. Sprinting the bike negates the entire pacing strategy.
- Trying to jump every rep when step-ups are permitted (65+). Step-ups protect the calves and ankles for the next event.
- Letting cadence slip in the back half. The second set of burpees is where you pay back the recovery you earned on the bike. Do not give it back.

Warm-Up

Phase 1 — General Elevation (5 min): Easy bike at progressive pace. Use the same bike type if available. Build heart rate into Yellow zone.

Phase 2 — Movement Preparation (5 min): Ankle circles, calf raises, glute bridges, hip flexor stretches, world's greatest stretch. Build up the squat pattern with air squats x 10. Open the hips and ankles — the burpee-to-jump cycle hammers both.

Phase 3 — Specific Ramp (8-10 min): 5 burpee box jump overs at competition height, building speed across the set. Walk it back. 5 more BBJO at race pace, focusing on cadence — one rep every 4-5 seconds. Then 90 seconds on the bike at your planned race pace to dial in the resistance and the rhythm. Step off, walk it off, breathe. 3-5 more BBJO at race pace to lock the cadence into the legs. Final 30 seconds on the bike at full race pace to confirm settings, then walk it off, hydrate, and visualize the first 50 reps. Total ramp work should leave you warm but fresh.

Cool-Down

Phase 1 — Aerobic Flush (3-5 min): Easy walk, bike, or row at Blue zone. Let heart rate settle back to Zone 1.

Phase 2 — Session-Specific Mobility (3-5 min): Calf stretch (45 sec/side), couch stretch (45 sec/side), hip flexor stretch, ankle mobility drills.

Phase 3 — Soft Tissue (3-5 min): Foam roll quads, calves, and IT band. Lacrosse ball on the glutes. Walk between events to keep the legs from stiffening up. You have events ahead.

EVENT 4 — TIE-DOWN

Time Cap: 13:00

Workout

For Time — Three descending rounds of:

- Double Unders
- Rope Climbs
- Sandbag Walking Lunge (35-54) or Dual DB Suitcase Lunge (55+)

Volumes descend (e.g., 150-100-50 double unders for 35-49 M). See standards table for exact prescriptions.

Age Group Standards

Age Group	Prescription
35-49 M	150-100-50 DU / 5-5-5 RC / 150-100-50 ft Sandbag Lunge 100 lb
35-49 F	150-100-50 DU / 5-5-5 RC / 150-100-50 ft Sandbag Lunge 70 lb
50-54 M	120-80-40 DU / 4-4-4 RC / 150-100-50 ft Sandbag Lunge 100 lb
50-54 F	120-80-40 DU / 4-4-4 RC / 150-100-50 ft Sandbag Lunge 70 lb
55-59 M	100-80-40 DU / 3-3-3 RC / 150-100-50 ft Dual DB Suitcase Lunge 35 lb
55-59 F	100-80-40 DU / 3-3-3 RC / 150-100-50 ft Dual DB Suitcase Lunge 20 lb
60-64 M	100-80-40 DU / 2-2-2 RC / 150-100-50 ft Dual DB Suitcase Lunge 35 lb
60-64 F	100-80-40 DU / 2-2-2 RC / 150-100-50 ft Dual DB Suitcase Lunge 20 lb
65+ M	100-80-40 DU / 1-1-1 RC / 150-100-50 ft Dual DB Suitcase Lunge 35 lb
65+ F	100-80-40 DU / 1-1-1 RC / 150-100-50 ft Dual DB Suitcase Lunge 20 lb

Strategic Overview

Zone: Orange. This is a longer workout with high reps — we are never targeting Red, but you may find yourself in the Red on the heaviest lunge stretches. The goal is sustained Orange across all three rounds, with the descending volumes giving you natural pacing relief.

The 13-minute cap is real. The athlete who finishes inside the cap manages three things: they hit double unders unbroken or near-unbroken, they execute rope climbs efficiently, and they pick a sustainable lunge rhythm and hold it. The descending rep schemes mean rounds 2 and 3 should feel faster, not slower — even as fatigue accumulates.

Pacing and Execution

Double unders — Rhythm is everything: Trip-ups cost more than fatigue. Set a steady cadence — around 3-4 reps per second — and stay tall. If you trip in the round of 150, do not panic; reset, breathe, restart. The descending volume is your friend; rounds 2 and 3 should feel easier than round 1.

Rope climbs — Conserve grip: Walk to the rope, take a breath, climb deliberately. The descent is just as important as the ascent — lower controlled, do not slide. Skin and grip are both protected by a clean descent. The fewer climbs in your division (1 per round at 65+, 2-3 at 55-64), the more methodical each one should be.

Sandbag walking lunge (35-54): Sandbag on the shoulder. Switch shoulders between rounds or mid-stretch as needed — do not let one shoulder do all the work, especially over 150 feet. Each step should be a controlled drop into the lunge, knee touches the floor lightly, drive through the front heel to stand. Eyes forward, chest up. Plan your shoulder switches in advance: round 1 right, round 2 left, round 3 alternate halfway.

Dual DB suitcase lunge (55+): Dumbbells held at the sides. The midline demand is high — stay tall, do not let the shoulders round forward, do not let the hips shift side to side. Steady rhythm. If you need to pause, pause at the top of a rep, not mid-step.

Key Mistakes to Avoid

- Trying to power through double unders when the rhythm breaks down. Stop, reset for 2 seconds, restart clean.
- Sliding down the rope on descent. Saves a second, costs skin, and rushes the next movement. Lower controlled.
- Carrying the sandbag on the same shoulder for the entire stretch. Plan shoulder switches in advance.
- Lunging with a forward-leaning torso under the dumbbells. Stay tall — the low back will tell you why later if you do not.

Warm-Up

Phase 1 — General Elevation (5 min): Easy bike or row to Yellow zone. Single-unders for 1-2 minutes to wake up the calves and the rope rhythm.

Phase 2 — Movement Preparation (5-7 min): Wrist circles, lat stretches, banded shoulder activations, walking lunges x 20, world's greatest stretch, ankle rocks.

Phase 3 — Specific Ramp (8-10 min): 30 double unders at race pace, focus on rhythm and a tall posture. Walk it off. 1 rope climb at moderate effort to lock in the foot-lock and descent control. 25-50 ft of lunges with the competition implement at race pace, focus on the shoulder load (sandbag) or midline (DB). Walk it off. Then a full mini-round at race pace: 30 DU → 1 rope climb → 25 ft lunge to feel the full transition rhythm. 2-3 minutes of breathing and visualization. Set up your jump rope, your rope climb lane, and your lunge implement before the start — know the path you are walking.

Cool-Down

Phase 1 — Aerobic Flush (3-5 min): Easy walk, bike, or row at Blue zone. Let heart rate settle back to Zone 1.

Phase 2 — Session-Specific Mobility (3-5 min): Wrist and forearm stretches, lat stretch on the rig, couch stretch (45 sec/side), hip flexor stretch, calf stretch.

Phase 3 — Soft Tissue (3-5 min): Foam roll quads and IT band. Lacrosse ball on forearms and lats. Wrist mobility circles. Hydrate, refuel. You have events ahead.

EVENT 5 — SEMI-GWEN

Time Cap: 8:00

Workout

For Time — Unbroken Clean and Jerks. Sets are descending. The bar may not be set down between reps within a set. If the bar touches the floor or is set in a rack, the set ends and any remaining reps in that set are forfeit.

- Set 1, Set 2, Set 3 (descending volumes vary by division)

Age Group Standards

Age Group	Prescription
35-39 M	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 185 lb
35-39 F	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 125 lb
40-44 M	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 165 lb
40-44 F	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 115 lb
45-49 M	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 155 lb
45-49 F	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 105 lb
50-54 M	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 135 lb
50-54 F	15-12-9 unbroken C&J at 95 lb
55-59 M	12-9-6 unbroken C&J at 115 lb
55-59 F	12-9-6 unbroken C&J at 75 lb
60-64 M	12-9-6 unbroken C&J at 95 lb
60-64 F	12-9-6 unbroken C&J at 65 lb
65+ M	10-8-6 unbroken C&J at 75 lb
65+ F	10-8-6 unbroken C&J at 55 lb

Strategic Overview

Zone: Battery work at its finest. Three short, all-out sets with full recovery between. This is not a pacing event in the traditional sense — this is about producing maximum power on each set and using the rest periods to fully restore between efforts.

Battery sessions like this train the body to produce high-output efforts repeatedly when given enough recovery. Total volume is moderate — 36 reps for 35-54, 27 reps for 55-64, 24 reps for

65+ — but the unbroken constraint means each set is a sustained, high-intensity burst. The penalty for breaking is severe: a failed set forfeits remaining reps in that set and can collapse a leaderboard placement instantly.

The strategic question is not how hard to push within a set — you push everything within a set. The question is rest management between sets and bar-cycling efficiency within sets. The athlete who treats each set as its own event, fully resets between sets, and executes flawless touch-and-go cycling wins this one.

Pacing and Execution

Set 1 — The big set: This is the longest set. 15 reps (or 12, or 10) of unbroken touch-and-go clean and jerks at moderately heavy loads. Cycle methodically — the goal is sustainable rhythm within the set, not max speed. Drop fast from the lockout, catch the bar in a quarter-squat, ride it down, stand it back up. Breathe at the top of every jerk lockout. Treat this as a single battery effort.

Rest between sets — Take what you need: Battery work demands full recovery. After Set 1, walk away from the bar. Hands on hips, breathe through the nose, slow heart rate. 60-90 seconds is the typical window. The temptation is to rush back to the bar to chase the clock. Resist. A 60-90 second recovery before Set 2 is faster than a failed Set 2 at 30 seconds.

Set 2 — The grind: Same execution. Touch-and-go, methodical cycling within the set, breathe at lockout. The legs will feel heavy from Set 1; that is expected. Trust the technique. If the bar feels off after rep 5, slow the rhythm and finish the set — do not speed up.

Set 3 — Finish it: By Set 3 the heart rate is at its peak and the legs are toast. Take a longer rest if needed (60-75 seconds). The final set is the shortest — 9, 6, or 6 reps depending on division. Pick up the bar with intention. One unbroken set away from the finish line.

Key Mistakes to Avoid

- Cycling too fast in Set 1. Speed kills here. A controlled rep-per-3-seconds rhythm finishes the set — a 1-second-per-rep blast does not.
- Rushing back to the bar between sets. The 60-90 seconds of recovery is the difference between a clean set and a missed lift.
- Crashing the bar back to the shoulders from the jerk. Catch in a quarter-squat, ride it down, save the wrists and elbows.
- Setting the bar down to fix grip mid-set. The set ends. There is no recovery from a forfeit.

Warm-Up

Phase 1 — General Elevation (5 min): Easy bike or row to Yellow zone. The legs need to be warm — every clean is a front squat under the bar.

Phase 2 — Movement Preparation (5-7 min): Wrist circles, banded shoulder distractions, hip openers, ankle rocks, front rack mobility (PVC or empty barbell). PVC pass-throughs and overhead positioning. Spend extra time on front rack flexibility — every clean lands here.

Phase 3 — Specific Ramp (8-10 min): Empty barbell clean and jerks x 5 → 30-50% x 3 → 60-70% x 2 → 80% x 2 → 90% x 1 → working weight x 2 (touch-and-go to confirm bar cycling).

Then walk away, breathe, and hold the visualization for 2-3 minutes. Final 30 seconds: stand over the bar, hands on the bar, ready to lift.

Cool-Down

Phase 1 — Aerobic Flush (3-5 min): Easy walk, bike, or row at Blue zone. This is critical after a max-intensity barbell event — keep moving to prevent the legs from seizing.

Phase 2 — Session-Specific Mobility (3-5 min): Wrist and forearm stretches, banded shoulder distractions, couch stretch (45 sec/side), hip flexor stretch, thoracic openers.

Phase 3 — Soft Tissue (3-5 min): Foam roll quads, IT band, and lats. Lacrosse ball on the upper traps and forearms. Wrist circles. Hydrate aggressively, refuel with carbs and protein within 30 minutes.

BETWEEN-EVENT RECOVERY PROTOCOL

The athlete who manages recovery between events outperforms the athlete who only manages execution during events. Use the windows between heats to compound your readiness.

Within 5 Minutes Post-Event

- Walk it off. Do not sit immediately. Keep moving for 3-5 minutes to flush the legs and clear lactate.
- Hydrate. 8-12 oz of water with electrolytes. Sip, do not chug.
- Begin the cool-down sequence specific to the event you just finished.

15-30 Minutes Post-Event

- Refuel. 30-50 grams of carbs and 15-25 grams of protein. Easy-to-digest options: rice cakes with honey, banana with whey shake, white rice with chicken, Greek yogurt with fruit, sports drink with simple carbs.
- Get off your feet. Sit, elevate the legs if possible. Use the camp chair.
- Stay warm. Sweatshirt and sweatpants on. Cold muscles do not perform; warm muscles do.
- Mental reset. Review the next event — standards, your pacing plan, the warm-up protocol. Visualize the first 30 seconds.

60+ Minutes Before Next Event

- Light snack if needed. Avoid heavy meals close to event time.
- Begin the next event's warm-up protocol with 25-30 minutes to spare. Do not be rushed.
- Final hydration check. Bathroom break. Chalk and gear ready.
- Step into your warm-up with intention. The next event starts when you start preparing for it.

COMPETITION DAY CHECKLIST

Gear

- Lifters / training shoes (both)
- Jump rope (your own, even if one is provided)
- Wrist wraps and lifting belt
- Knee sleeves (optional but recommended for the lunge event)
- Tape (athletic + finger if needed)
- Chalk (your own block, do not rely on the venue chalk)
- Extra shirt and socks
- Sweatshirt and sweatpants (stay warm between events)
- Camp chair (get off your feet between events)
- Foam roller and lacrosse ball
- Resistance bands (light and heavy)

Nutrition and Hydration

- Water bottle (32 oz minimum, refilled throughout the day)
- Electrolyte tabs or pre-mixed drink (LMNT, Liquid IV, or equivalent)
- Pre-event snacks: rice cakes, bananas, dates, energy gels
- Post-event recovery: protein shake powder, bananas, Greek yogurt
- Real meal between heats if more than 2 hours apart: rice and chicken, sandwich, easy-to-digest
- Avoid: heavy fats, fried food, high-fiber meals on competition day

Mental Prep

- This guide. Re-read your event plan in the 30 minutes before each warm-up.
- Headphones and music if you use them. Know your hype playlist and your calm playlist.
- A notebook or notes app. Write down splits, weights moved, lessons after each event.

Documents

- Athlete check-in confirmation
- ID for check-in
- Heat sheet / event order (printed or screenshot)

Trust your training.

Execute your plan.



Fortune favors the bold.